

THE GARAMUT



A MESSAGE SENDER

*Ps Barry's
Reflections on:*
**PRAYER,
PROCLAMATION and
PERSONAL PROGRESS**

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LESSONS FROM THE LIFE OF THE APOSTLE PAUL

OUR FOCUS:

LOOKING AT THE PATTERNS FOR MINISTRY THAT ARE DRAWN FROM
IMPACTFUL STATEMENTS OF THE APOSTLE PAUL THAT ARE WORTHY OF
TAKING TIME TO NOTE.

PATTERNS OF MINISTRY THAT ALL BELIEVERS AND LEADERS CAN FOLLOW.

PAUL'S ILLUSTRATION OF PARENTS/FATHERS

SPIRITUAL PARENTS (fathers, shepherds, leaders) LAYING UP OR PROVIDING FOR their spiritual children.

- * Children who have believed in Christ as a result of a person who first presented the gospel to them or have become part of a local church flock and are now entrusted into the care of that person, who **has become like a FATHER or a PARENT**, providing spiritual guidance and care for them.

- * **Example - 1 Corinthians 4:15** *Through the Good News I became your father in Christ Jesus,* **EMPHASIZING**

THE PREPAREDNESS OF FATHERS OR PARENTS TO SACRIFICE, SPEND & BE SPENT FOR THE BENEFIT OF THEIR SPIRITUAL CHILDREN.

- * This quality of spiritual fathers and parents is amazing and delightful to observe because it exemplifies what our Heavenly Father is like towards each of us.
- * This quality is something that is needed in engaging in the work of mentoring and making disciples.

FATHERS/PARENTS who seek NOT YOURS - BUT YOU"

2 Corinthians 12:14

*14 Now I am ready to visit you for the third time, and I will not be a burden to you, because what I want **is not your possessions** but you. After all, children should not have to save up for their parents, but parents for their children.*

**TRUE FATHERS SEEK THE PERSON
NOT THE PERSON'S POSSESSIONS**

- ▲ **THE JOYOUS OBLIGATION OF PARENTS WILLINGNESS TO SPEND (give to) AND BE SPENT FOR THEIR CHILDREN**

- * **TO SPEND** = GIVE of themselves and their possessions because they are true fathers.

- * **BE SPENT** = willing to be used, misused, and not appreciated and with no regret of loss to themselves. **THIS IS WHAT FATHERS DO.**

2 Corinthians 12:15 So I will very gladly spend for you everything I have and expend myself as well. If I love you more, will you love me less? NIV

- ▲ **THE RISK – THE VULNERABILITY OF LOVING**

- * Spiritual parents are aware that loving their spiritual children does not necessarily guarantee that parents will be appreciated (i.e. loved more or less).

APPLICATION

- * **Spiritual Parents/Fathers need to understand and be prepared for this kind of situation, because it is not about them receiving appreciation or thanks but more about the welfare of their children.**

▲ **THE APOSTLE'S DECLARED PASSIONATE DESIRE AND PRAYER IS FOR HIS OWN PEOPLE (Israel) TO BE SAVED**

Romans 10:1 Brothers and sisters, my heart's desire and prayer to God for the Israelites is that they may be saved. NIV

Romans 9:1-3

"..... there is something that makes me feel very depressed, like a pain that never leaves me. It is the condition of my brothers and fellow-Israelites, and I have actually reached the pitch of wishing myself CUT OFF from Christ if it meant that they could be won for God.

J.B Phillips

Romans 9:2-3

2 I have great sorrow and unceasing anguish in my heart.

3 For I could wish that I myself were CURSED and CUT OFF from Christ for the sake of my brothers, those of my own race, (Israel) NIV

- ▲ **THE APOSTLE'S deep sorrow and pain that he felt for his people to be saved cause him to express himself in this extreme way (cut off from Christ), BUT THIS ISN'T A LITERAL DESIRE THAT HE BE DAMNED, BUT AN EXPRESSION of the extreme depth of his love and pain for his brethren Israel.**
- ▲ **Paul is also making this strong statement to show he has not become hostile or indifferent to his fellow Jews simply because he is a missionary to the Gentiles.**

APPLICATION

- * **How passionate are we about the lost being saved?**

▲ **THE APOSTLE'S OBLIGATION AS A DEBTOR TO ALL PEOPLES**

Romans 1:13-15 AMP

14 Both to Greeks and to barbarians (to the cultured and to the uncultured), both to the wise and the foolish, I have an OBLIGATION to discharge and a DUTY to perform and a DEBT to pay.

15 So, for my part, I am willing and eagerly ready to preach the Gospel to you also who are in Rome. AMP

▲ **THE APOSTLE DECLARES THAT YOU MAY HAVE MANY INSTRUCTORS – BUT NOT MANY FATHERS**

1 Corinthians 4:15-16

15 For you can have 10,000 instructors in Christ, but you can't have many fathers. Now I have fathered you in Christ Jesus through the gospel.

16 Therefore I urge you, be imitators of me. HOLMAN BIBLE

1 Corinthians 4:15-16

15 For though you may have ten thousand teachers in Christ, you do not have many fathers. Through the Good News I became your father in Christ Jesus,

16 so I beg you, please follow my example. NCV

▲ **WHAT IS THE DIFFERENCE BETWEEN FATHER AND INSTRUCTORS?**

- ▲ **INSTRUCTORS** can teach truth and give direction but are not always present to explain to the children such truth and direction is processed and outworked in practical terms so that the children fully understand.

If you **tell** me, I'll forget.

If you **show** me, I'll remember.

If you **involve** me, I'll understand.

But someone has to be walking **with** them for them to understand.

- ▲ **FATHERS** are those who are constantly **available** and **present** for his children to love, care, direct, restore through **all** circumstances and events of life.

- * This is regardless of whether the children's choices are agreed with or not, and a father is able to admit to his Children that he does not have all the answers to their questions but asks them to accompany him in the journey of finding those answers. **THAT'S WHAT FATHER'S DO.**

- **Apostle said: I BEG YOU, PLEASE FOLLOW MY EXAMPLE. NCV**

Amen - Ps. Barry